

MAN'S RELATIONSHIP TO TIME

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. Blessings for every one of you. Blessings for your work on this path.

Every living organism experiences certain visible changes that represent milestones in his process of growth. When I speak of a living organism, this does not only refer to an individual. A group such as this is a living organism. It represents a body of growth because it stands on a healthy foundation, enabling many more individuals, in time, to cultivate their own growth. Every one of my friends who participates in this work contributes to the inner growth of this group. Many of you are doing your very best to grow out of confusion and error. Thereby you contribute. Some of you also help through outer deeds, efforts, and assistance, each in your own way. All such help and contribution is of great value, and the universal, cosmic forces thank such people in their own way. Such thanks, if we may call it that for lack of a better word, take the form of particular blessings that are not easily and instantly recognizable. Only upon deep meditation can their reality be perceived. Such particular blessings are coming forth tonight, to all present as well as absent. Such universal, divine gratitude exists, my friends. May all of you, my friends, who are helping with your inner and outer assistance, feel the reality of these blessings. Every one of you has a different possibility of contributing towards the growth of this "body of truth," but the facing of the self in utter candor represents the main contribution so that this group will continue to remain on the healthy foundation upon which it now stands.

The growth of a living organism cannot always be evaluated by outer signs. This holds true for a group as well as for an individual. But anyone with an open and sensitive mind can perceive such growth and inner health even if, at times, there are no outer changes nor obvious manifestations. However, there are times when such an outer change is noticeable, and this is such a time. The fact that we are now housed in new quarters represents such a milestone. Divine blessings go forth to all of you who made this growth possible; to this new venture. Whenever such milestones come to pass in the process of growing, the inner reality can be sensed by all who have contributed towards it by their deeds, by their work of self-confrontation. May this be the case now. May you all be flooded by a wave of hope and security that you live in a benign universe in which you have nothing to fear.

Tonight, I should like to discuss a new topic. It considers man's relationship to time. This is indeed an important subject. My words will be very helpful if you take the trouble of pondering over them and trying to apply them to yourself. What I will say first may seem utterly inapplicable to your personal lives because of their abstract, philosophical, and metaphysical nature. But if you have patience with me and try to follow the words in their deeper meaning, you will soon see that they have, indeed, a very practical application.

Man's existence on earth, in the dimension of the earth atmosphere, is bound by time. On a previous occasion, I discussed the fact that time is a product of mind. Without mind, time does not exist. Time, space, and movement, in this dimension, are three separate factors. When a higher degree of consciousness is reached, and with it, an extended dimension; time, space, and movement unify more and more until they become one. It is an error to believe that the next dimension is timelessness. There are many extended "times," if I may use this expression, in higher realms of being, long before you reach the state of being that is timeless. It will be impossible for man to grasp this. The best you can do is sense this truth occasionally.

Time is a very limiting factor. It is a fragment, cut of a wider and freer dimension of experience. Now, this limited fragment given to man, called time, is put at man's disposal, in which he can grow, fulfill himself, experience, live, reach happiness and liberation up to the degree commensurate with this dimension. To the degree man fulfills this potential through inner growth, to that degree will life be a dynamic and full experience in which the limitation of time will not represent a hardship or a problem.

At this point, because it has so much bearing on this question, I would like to interject once again that it is possible to be on such a path of self-development, on the whole, and nevertheless miss out on many an occasion of growing. How many times does it happen to all of you that you find yourself in a negative mood without learning the deep lesson of it, without seeing its significance to your innermost being! -- when you simply wait for it to pass by itself. More and more often you will be exposed to such periods of depression, anxiety, uncertainty, disharmony. And it will become more difficult to find the real inner cause. In these instances, time is not utilized, and it thereby becomes a burden and a conflict which I will discuss a little later. But if each opportunity of growth is used through the work on such a path, through going to the roots of each negative happening or mood, if then a deep understanding and liberation is experienced, then the exhilaration and such confidence in life and in yourself as you now experience only occasionally will become more or less a permanent state. You will then be at one with the time element of your dimension, thereby organically growing into an extended dimension.

Listlessness, depression, impatience, nervousness, anxiety, tension, frustration, boredom, apathy, hostility -- all these emotions, and many others are, in the last analysis, a result of unutilized time, of not doing the utmost that is potentially possible in order to understand yourself and to dissolve inner conflict and confusion.

To those of my friends who have experienced liberation of such emotions with the influx of strength and inner joy, with the feeling that they are at one with life, I say, you can repeat this by not shirking the effort of truly looking deep into yourselves until you discover the origin of the negative emotions. If you remember these times of liberation, they were always connected with such efforts on your part. And to those of you who did not as yet have this experience because you may be too new on this path, I say, it can be yours if you do the necessary work.

Now you may ask what bearing this has on the question of your relationship to time. If you analyze each negative emotion, you will find that it stands in conflict with the limited fragment of time at your disposal. This may be a very good meditation exercise and may well lend itself to further and deeper exploration of this topic. All feelings that are constructive, realistic, and positive do not stand in conflict with time because time is utilized as it is destined to.

The vague knowledge that the time at your disposal is limited in this particular dimension, at this particular period of being in this dimension, creates a special tension. Therefore man strives to get out of this limitation, "time." He strains just as a dog pulls at his leash. Time holds you in the grip of a limitation, a limited area. The unconscious has a memory of the great experience of timelessness. It tries to find back into this limitless freedom. This can be done by accepting and fully utilizing the fragment "time." Then the transition will be an organic flow with a minimum of conflict. Or it can be done by straining into it without utilizing time in the meaningful way described here and as taught by all spiritual teachers and truth teachings. Then conflict and tension arise.

All spiritual, metaphysical or philosophical concepts, ideas, or postulates -- if they are truthful -- find their practical application in man's psychological attitudes. This is exactly how you can realize and corroborate any truth that is given to you.

Let us now discuss the particular conflict that man has regarding time. Each one of you has the possibility of finding out the truth of what I say, provided you take the necessary steps of self-investigation. As I have already indicated, on the one hand, man strives into a freer dimension of time. Translated into practical life, this manifests by striving into a tomorrow. If you observe yourself closely from this particular viewpoint, you will find it to be true in so many instances. At times, this is quite obvious and on the surface. In other instances, it is a vague general climate that permeates you and is therefore not as easily recognizable.

Man strives into the future for several reasons. He does not like the present and hopes for something better from the future. He fears a certain aspect of life and wants it to be past. His vague hopes from the future and the unpleasant unfulfilled state of the present are, in the main, his reasons for straining away from the present into a future, and thereby not living in the now. If, on the other hand, he were to explore within himself the reasons for his unfulfillment and difficulties which cause him to strain away from them (by, of course, first becoming aware that such feelings exist), he would be capable of living in the now fully, meaningfully, and dynamically, deriving all the many joys of each moment that he now overlooks. If each moment were truly lived to its fullest, by this very fact, you would already reach an extended dimension of time even while simultaneously still remaining in this dimension. In other words, only by fully utilizing the dimension you live in, can you truly outgrow it. Only by experiencing everything each moment of time's content will you no longer strain away and thereby automatically flow in the next time dimension.

As always, awareness is the first step. So do become aware of this inner striving away from the now. When you do so, you will then find that you do so because you do not realistically find and resolve the factors that cause you to strain into the future. This will give you the best inkling of one side of the conflict man has regarding time.

On the other side of the conflict, the picture is entirely opposite. Man fears the future while he strives into it. Future also means death and decay. So while he strains into the future for a hope of fulfillment, he simultaneously stems against the tide of time, desiring to hold it or to even go backwards into youth. He wants two impossible things. He wants the fulfillment of the future in the past or, at least, in the present. Thus two contradictory soul movements exist. One strains

forward, the other stems back. Needless to say, the soul suffers by this tension, by this unrealistic, useless, and destructive waste of energy.

Some time ago, I discussed man's fear of death. This fear is an integral part of his conflict with time. It causes the backward movement. The natural movement of time is a steady, harmonious flow. If man finds into this rhythm and harmony, he will be in harmony. But he can do so by being in time in the only meaningful way -- that is, by using each moment and incident for growth. By not straining away from the future, he will not have to fear it. By not straining away from the present, he will utilize it, and it will thereby not seem desirable to strain away from it. This is being. If it is not yet the highest state of being, it is the state of being commensurate with the dimension of time that you live in.

In this state, you follow the natural flow. The wave of time will bring you naturally and gracefully, as it were, into a next and extended dimension which you fear so much because you cannot prove its reality. But, on the one hand, your very haste to get into this dimension and, on the other hand, your very fear of the unknown and what seems so uncertain to a part of your personality causes you to restrain the natural movement and to create a tension through the setting of the soul forces into opposing directions. This in turn causes a certain stagnation of growth, as well as of the full experience of each "now."

The psychological value of these factors, after you determine this subtle but nevertheless very distinct inner double motion, is to understand the nature of the emotions and attitudes responsible for the contradictory soul movements.

If you strain forward, you do so because, in one way or another, you do not recognize certain functions in your particular life that could be fulfilled. You somehow let opportunities slip by. Of course, I do not now speak of outer opportunities and fulfillments although this may often be a final result of missed inner opportunities for growth and unfoldment of the soul, for resolution of inner conflict and dissolution of inner error. The daily review I advocate is one of the best means toward living each day and each hour fully. And I venture to say that all my friends who work so diligently on this path, have at least occasionally experienced that special peace that is full of a spark of aliveness, that is dynamic as it is peaceful, after they recognize in all its depth a distortion or a negative attitude in themselves. If such a recognition is profound enough, if out of it is derived all that is contained in it, then this wonderful feeling of being alive is bound to occur. The fact that the recognition itself may be very unflattering and disillusioning about oneself, and at times even painful, will not diminish the great experience once the recognition is full and complete. On the contrary, this may furnish the best proof of the reality of my words in this lecture. Also, you may use this very experience as a yardstick. Whenever a self-confrontation does not, in the end, produce such an experience, you have not found all that there is. This knowledge should not make you impatient or tense, but it should give you to understand that somehow you are hedging the truth. You do not wish to see all there is to see. This awareness will open you up so that you will eventually derive the maximum experience out of the particular incident in question. You will cultivate the inner will to face and see and understand in yourself all there is to confront and comprehend. Then and then only will you experience the exhilaration of having fulfilled yourself to the utmost at this moment. Then you will no longer tug at time in diametrically opposite directions.

Have you ever thought, my friends, why it should be that after an unflattering or painful recognition (provided you go to its very depth and do not stop halfway), you should experience such a dynamic state of harmony and aliveness? It is so only because at that moment you have fully utilized that which is given to you, the fragment of time that is at your disposal. When you are listless and depressed or in any way unhappy, the material is there, right in front of you. You are right in it, but you are blind to it. You do not focus your attention on it. Therefore you try to get out of this "now" without utilizing it. That is the forward movement which, at the same time, is responsible for your fear of growing into death -- which actually is a threshold to life. Therefore you hold back while you push forward.

Fear of death exists in many forms and shapes. I do not wish to go into detail on what I said on this subject before, but only to say that spiritual or religious belief, if it is superimposed, is as much a facet of fear of death as a violent protestation of the opposite. They are but two different sides of the same coin.

The only way to experience the flow of time that knows no interruption, that brings you into extended dimensions is to utilize each living moment in the manner you learn to do on this path. Then you no longer deal with concepts which you adopt or reject, which you agree or disagree with. Then an inner experience comes into being that makes you know that this mold of time is only one facet of another mold of time -- it can be but a fragment of a bigger piece. This, in itself, is the knowledge that death is but an illusion. It is merely a manifestation of transition into a different dimension. However, such words can be meaningful only if you make the experience of their reality possible. For that, this pathwork gives you ample opportunity.

Are there any questions pertaining to this topic? When you reread this lecture, you may then come across many more questions or passages that are not quite clear. The discussion groups will henceforth be conducted according to a new plan. You will be afforded an opportunity to gain further clarification, provided you take the effort of cooperating, of searching for what you wish to understand on a deeper level. Such participation on your part is essential, for otherwise my words will remain but words -- and that is not good enough.

QUESTION: You say that once one leaves this dimension or concept of time, one enters another concept of time which involves unification of space, time, and movement. Will you please clarify that?

ANSWER: Yes, I will try. In your dimension, time and space are two separate factors. To give you a practical example, you find yourself in a certain space. If you wish to find yourself in another space, you require time to get there. In order to bridge the distance, movement is necessary. So, movement is the bridge that combines time and space. In the next dimension, where there is a wider fragment of what you may call time -- which is still far from timelessness -- there, movement, time, and space are one. In other words, you are in one space. You think of the space you now wish to be in. The movement required to bridge the distance is your thought. It is of a shorter span of time and motion. That thought, which is movement, brings you into another area of space, regardless of the distance as measured in your dimension. Do you understand that?

QUESTION: Yes. But it brings two questions to mind. One is can this happen on earth? And two is that I saw a TV program recently which explained that in outer space, as we know it

today, this adjustment via movement through time and space takes place so that the time changes according to the rate of speed you are traveling in space. I don't quite understand it?

ANSWER: It is not possible on earth with material means. However, it is possible in any sphere with the means that are compatible with that dimension. In other words, the spirit, the psyche, is of course capable of experiencing this. In fact, it experiences it constantly, only the waking brain is rarely aware of this experience. But the physical body is incapable of this experience because it is made and adjusted to this limited dimension in which a separation between time and space exists, the bridge of these being movement.

As to your second question, when material and technical means have been invented to leave this dimension, an inkling of this factor becomes accessible to material brain knowledge. But whether or not this discovery is understood in its profounder meaning depends, of course, on the individual, on the capacity and willingness of people to understand. I might add here that the technical knowledge that brought this cosmic truth into your material world -- the same truth that I approached here from a different angle -- is but a consequence of a general, overall readiness of this earth sphere to grasp higher truth. If in spite of its possibility for growth that brought forward such higher truth into its grasp, mankind still does not learn from it the deeper meaning, it will stagnate with all the destructive results of such stagnation. It is exactly the same process as with an individual. He who has more potential to grow but does not utilize it will be a more troubled soul than the one who may actually exert less effort in the direction of his development, but he is closer to his given potential. This explains why it is impossible to judge and compare.

To get back to your question, the technical discoveries are one way of helping mankind to understand this broader awareness. But if this technical discovery does not lead to this broader and deeper understanding, such discoveries will not only be useless, they will even be destructive. The constructiveness and benefit of every discovery depends on whether or not mankind, as a whole, understands spiritual and cosmic law on a deeper level than before such a discovery. If this happens, it will help mankind to produce a greater inner freedom, faster growth and development -- and therefore outer peace and justice in an increased measure.

If history is observed from this point of view, it will be found that all earth upheavals ever experienced are a result of broader knowledge not used with the proper understanding. The links between such new knowledge in certain eras, and the subsequent upheavals due to the ignorance of its real meaning, could be established if historians undertaking such a search are themselves in a fully growing life process. New knowledge is not necessarily and exclusively of a technical nature. It can be an influx in art, philosophy, or any realm of experience. These links are not immediately visible, but they are there. It might be an interesting study for a historian who has the inner equipment to see what first seems obscure, but which stands out clearly once one's attention is focused in the right direction. What you cited in your second question is really exactly the same, in technical terms, as that which I explained in philosophical and psychological terms.

Now, my friends, prepare more questions for our next session together. All questions not directly connected with this topic can be asked after the next lecture. However, if you have a sufficient number of general questions not pertaining to either of the lectures which come up for discussion, we may arrange for another question-and-answer session. Or I may adjust the next

lecture in length according to the number of questions you have prepared for me. These are difficult subjects, indeed, and there is no use giving you more material than you can absorb.

My dearest friends, be blessed again, every one of you. May these words not merely pass through your brain. May they indeed give you the incentive to listen deep within yourself in order to gain, on the one hand, a little distance from yourself; and, on the other, just by doing so, just by gaining more objectivity, may you therefore become more at home within yourself. Thus you will feel more at ease with life -- in this fragment of time so that you may utilize fearlessly, without straining into the future, without stemming against it, thereby being in harmony with the flow of time. May you thus, gradually, little by little, through the discoveries about your innermost, hidden attitudes and emotions, find yourself in the harmony of flowing with the wave of time, living each now to the fullest. May all of my good friends -- those who are present here, and those who are absent, and those who are new, and those who are hesitant, and those who may contemplate to begin a new way of inner life -- may you all find your self and thus eventually overcome the barrier that makes you tend to the visible manifestation while being blind to that which causes it.

Be in peace. May you find the strength and the reality that I try to help you find. Be blessed!
Be in God!

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